

Forward plan — reading order and glossary

Canonical name: `01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md`
Date: 2026-06-25 (updated 2026-06-11 — symbol decoder)
From: COMPASS
To: Charles Levine
Purpose: Glossary and jargon decoder.
Print stack: use `Charles_reading_list.md` for the full ordered list (must-read #1–#6 vs reference #7–#13).
Advisor framing: Alex Gates = guidance · Dakota Murray = decision points (not automatic path changes).
Start here if lost: `Charles_reading_list.md` → this section (symbol decoder) → rest of glossary → read must-read #2–#6 in full.

Symbol systems — read this when § or # loses you

Agents reused § for three different things. That was never meant to be forward-facing. Default rule: if a doc does not say otherwise, §N = a section of the Word manuscript (`Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx` , Dakota Murray v03 spine, routed by #10).

The three (plus one) symbol systems

Symbol	Means	Example
#NN	Numbered reading-stack file in 3-Master_Plan/ or 5-Manuscript/	#07 = 07_Claim_language_guardrails.md
§N (default)	Manuscript Word outline section (Dakota v03)	"Ink §5 → §1 → §4" = generative → empirical triad → tenure; then §0 polish
§N in #12 only	Staging prose section — different numbering	Staging §4 = Predictions → paste into manuscript §7, not manuscript §4
§X inside one .md file	Subsection of that file only	#07 §F = prediction claims table row; #06 §3 = non-requirements block

Trap we created: "Write §4 predictions" in agent notes often meant staging #12 §4 (Predictions) → manuscript §7. Manuscript §4 is Academic Tenure Setting — completely different.

Manuscript § map (Word — what ink order uses)

§	Manuscript section (Dakota v03)	Primary ink source
§0	Opening framing (problem, gap, contribution, roadmap — ½–1 pp)	#12 §1
§1	Empirical Observation (Army, basketball, tenure triad)	#12 §2.2 + §3.4
§2	Why Might This Happen? (B vs D)	#12 §2.1 + #05
§3	From Global Competition to Constrained Distinction	#12 §2.1 + #05
§4	Academic Tenure Setting	#12 §3.4 tenure + #11 digest
§5	Minimal Generative Modeling	#12 §2.3 + §3.2
§6	Mechanism Decomposition	#12 §2.4
§7	Predictions and Validation	#12 §4 (staging)
§8	Network Science (deferred v1)	Keep Dakota text; defer
§9	Thoughts to Stimulate Feedback	Committee brief only

Your ink order (locked): manuscript §5 → §1 → §4 first — generative POC, then empirical legs, then tenure. Then §0 (opening frame, polish pass). Open #11 before manuscript §4 (tenure), not before predictions.

Lit review policy (v1): No separate front-loaded lit chapter. §0 = mini-intro; §2–§3 = conceptual citations; Discussion (#12 §5.2) = fuller literature placement.

Staging #12 § map (copy-from prose — not the same numbers)

Staging §	Topic	Goes to manuscript §
§1	Opening framing (manuscript §0)	§0
§2	Theory and framing	§1–§3, §6
§3	Methods	§1, §4, §5
§4	Predictions	§7
§5	Discussion and limitations	§2 closing, §6, new Discussion

When an old note says "VECTOR §3" or "§4 predictions," check whether it means staging #12 or manuscript Word — use the table above.

Repo-only shorthands (never bare in docs meant for you)

Shorthand	Full pointer (first mention rule)
530	sports/530_sports_pipeline.ipynb — empirical panel + overlap (CELL 8)
537	sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb — sort-and-chop falsification
538 / 538D	sports/538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb / sports/538D_development.ipynb
540	540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb — tenure Cox Layer B (pre-submission)
CELL 4D	Sub-block under CELL 4 in 538D — letter D, not four dimensions
D10	Export bundle — file list in #08

Numbered active docs (quick map)

#	File	Role
01	01_forward_plan_reading_guide.md	This file — glossary
02	02_Charles_decisions_locked.md	Your Tier 1 locks (already filed)
03	03_Where_we_are_now.md	Project status today
04	04_Project_story_plain_English.md	Plain-English story
05	../5-Manuscript/05_Model_Nesting_Note_v1.md	One ontology $L_{\text{net}} = B - D$
06	06_Generative_closure_checklist.md	SCOUT C1–C8 checklist
07	07_Claim_language_guardrails.md	What you may / may not claim
08	08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md	D10 bundle file list
09	09_Tenure_export_on_disk.md	Inference export numbers
10	../5-Manuscript/10_Manuscript_ink_map.md	Section routing for Word
11	../5-Manuscript/11_Dakota_feedback_decision_points.md	Dakota email → evaluate, not auto-follow
12	../5-Manuscript/12_Manuscript_staging_prose.md	Copy-from paragraphs
13	13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md	Pivotal framing (optional skim)
14	14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md	PD12 ladder relabel; B-lite closure (optional)
21	21_Formulas_and_variables.md	Formula / variable decoder
30	30_Alex_Gates_inform_status_outline.md	Alex inform brief (path map + appendix)

Long original names → obsolete/original_filenames/.

Returning after a break (June 2026) — use this path

Tier 1 already filed in 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md. Phase A exports done. **Do not re-litigate locks.**
Follow Charles_reading_list.md: must-read #1–#6 in full, then keep #7–#13 as reference while inking Word.

Deep-dive reading order (optional — original correspondence arc)

Use only if you want the full history behind the locks. **Not required** for manuscript inking.

Step	Document	Read for
0a	13_INSIGHT_NUGGETS.md	Pivotal perspectives
0b	docs/Menger/	Menger deep read (optional)
0	This file	Glossary
1	04_Project_story_plain_English.md	Plain-English story
2	20260615_1045_COMPASS_to_Charles_forward_plan_and_questions.md	Original action plan; that file’s §6–§7 question tiers (superseded by #02)
3	20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md	Alex PD12: four priorities
4	14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md	Ladder relabel; B-lite closure
5	07_Claim_language_guardrails.md	Claim discipline — §E, §F
6	06_Generative_closure_checklist.md	Green/yellow checklist

Skip for first pass: Round 1–5 correspondence in obsolete/; long overlap in 03_Where_we_are_now.md vs #04.

Two different “Tier” systems

Docs use **Tier** for two unrelated things. Check context.

A. Scientific tiers (story arc)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1	Phenomenon — inverted-U on LOO proxy (mostly done)
Tier 2	Minimal mechanism — generative POC; D10 packages it
Tier 2.5	Model-guided features — quality vs congestion (PD12)
Tier 3	Predictions — named candidates, not fully proven
Tier 4	Manuscript — write the paper

B. Question tiers (your decisions — obsolete forward plan §6)

Tier	Meaning
Tier 1 questions	Answer first — unblocks SCOUT, PEER, VECTOR (items 1–10 in obsolete forward plan §6)
Tier 2 questions	Softer prose/methods — OK to say “ use agent defaults ” (§6 items 11+ in that file)
Tier 3+	Alex meeting, AWS, optional routes — not blocking this week

Tier 1 question IDs (memorize these five blocks):

- **SCOUT**: Q-SCOUT-9 (folder path), Q-D10 (go on export bundle)
- **PEER**: C1 (OpenAlex tiers), C2 (CSV names)
- **VECTOR**: C12–C13 (predictions + outline), V1–V3 (manuscript priority + timing)
- **COMPASS**: Q-DEFAULTS (accept Tier 2 defaults?)

Status: Answered in `02_Charles_decisions_locked.md`.

Rung / ladder (plain English)

Not a code pipeline. **Steps in the paper argument**, in order (see also `#05` §3, `#14` Q1):

Rung 1	Phenomenon	→ inverted-U exists (Army, basketball; tenure preliminary)
Rung 2	Minimal model	→ talent-only fails; congestion-in-score POC (basketball)
Rung 2.5	Model-guided feats	→ quality vs congestion columns (mostly built; D10 exports)
Rung 3	Predictions	→ #1 near-threshold, #2 Λ – candidates, not fully validated
Rung 4	Manuscript	→ ink Word under Path II

Ladder = climb these rungs when writing; do not jump from “we found a curve” to “submit the paper” without the middle steps Alex (PD12) cares about.

Rung 2.5 was added in the June PD12 reassessment because Alex’s ladder includes “**theory proposes new measurements**” (Priority 3) — not only phenomenon + minimal sim + predictions. It names what SCOUT already built (`poolq_loo` vs `crowding_smooth` , near-threshold export).

Paths (manuscript architecture)

Path	Meaning	v1?
Path II (locked)	3 empirical inverted-U legs + one basketball generative POC; honest axis mismatch	Yes
Path I	Generative sim must match LOO pool-quality axis bin-for-bin	No — parallel / post-v1

Path II = Charles’s “**manuscript-first**” lock (2026-06-11): write the paper with honest layering; do **not** block the draft on generative LOO bin-for-bin match or 3-domain parametric fit.

B-lite closure — where the name came from

Origin: COMPASS label in `14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md` **Question 2** (2026-06-15), after you re-read Alex’s PD12 guidance. Agents needed a word for “strong enough for Alex, weak enough for v1.”

Not Alex’s term — he describes priorities; **B-lite** is our shorthand for the **adopted closure standard**:

Option	Standard	v1?
A	Model reproduces the phenomenon	Too weak
B (full)	+ measurable + prediction + parametric identifiability across domains	Too strong — pulls PD12 Priority 1
B-lite (adopted)	Phenomenon + minimal mechanism POC + ≥1 model-guided measurement exported + ≥1 prediction readout + honest limits + D10 frozen bundle	Yes — matches Priority 3 without new science

Plain English: B-lite = “show the mechanism can work, export the measurements the model motivates, name the predictions, state the limits, freeze the folder” — **not** “identify every parameter in Army + basketball + tenure.”

Where it lives operationally: `06_Generative_closure_checklist.md` C1–C8 + D10 bundle (`#08`). **Five greens** (C1–C4 + C7, optionally C8) = B-lite satisfied for basketball generative leg.

Predictions #1 and #2 (Charles clarification)

Agents locked **two prediction slots** for manuscript structure — **not** “two proven results.”

#	Name	Empirical status today
#1	Near-threshold heterogeneity	Candidate. Exploratory export from <code>sports/538D_development.ipynb</code> CELL 4D → <code>heterogeneity_ventiles_top_tail.png</code> (<code>#08</code>); not formal cross-domain test.
#2	Peak shift with Λ	Placeholder / prose hook. No finished Λ figure in repo.

Do say: “primary prediction **directions.**”

Do not say: “predictions are fully validated across all settings” (see `07_Claim_language_guardrails.md` §F).

Shorthand glossary

Term	Plain English
COMPASS	Cross-project planner — sequencing, not domain code
CODA	Army agent
SCOUT	Basketball agent
PEER	Tenure agent
VECTOR	Your online ChatGPT Scholar agent (manuscript voice); also used as repo role label
PD12	Alex Gates paper-directions meeting, 2026-05-20
STANDING BY	Agent done debating; waiting on Charles only
Correspondence experiment	Rounds 1–5 agent mail — complete (in <code>obsolete/</code>)
LOO	Leave-one-out — peer pool excluding yourself
<code>poolq_loo</code>	LOO teammate pool quality (main empirical x-axis)
<code>crowding_smooth</code>	LOO congestion — density of viable peers above threshold
Λ (Lambda)	Global distinction capacity (slots, boards, draft picks)
D10	SCOUT export script — figures/tables in <code>08_Basketball_figures_on_disk.md</code>
Claim table	<code>07_Claim_language_guardrails.md</code>
B-lite closure	COMPASS coinage (2026-06-15, <code>#14</code> Q2): phenomenon + minimal mechanism POC + model-guided measurement exported + prediction readout + honest limits + D10 — not full 3-domain identifiability (“B full”)
Axis table	Maps model quantity ↔ empirical column ↔ setting (in D10 bundle)
Wang structure	Paper arc: phenomenon → mechanism → predictions
Wang move	Predict something you did not use to find the curve
Layer B	Tenure Cox cells 10–12 in <code>540_tenure_pipeline.ipynb</code> — pre- submission , not draft blocker
Dakota Murray v03	Committee RTF spine + <code>10_Manuscript_ink_map.md</code>
Generative POC	Small sim showing talent-only fails and congestion bends curves
POC	Same as generative POC — proof of concept (not “model finished”)
Pool mean	Whole-roster average — generative readout axis (≠ LOO axis)
LPM	Linear probability model — OLS on a binary outcome (drafted, tenured, etc.); often <code>Y ~ poolq_loo + poolq_loo²</code> for inverted-U shape (<code>538</code> CELL 5; <code>530</code> ventile overlay). Not final inference — logit/Cox when you need proper 0/1 or survival
L* (L-star)	Peak pool-quality level from a quadratic LPM (where expected Y is maximized) — Alex §6 step 2 in <code>538_alex_tier1_model_and_fit.ipynb</code>
empirical ladder	bins → LPM → logit → L* — descriptive ventiles, then parametric curvature, then proper link, then peak readout (<code>#03</code> basketball row; <code>538</code>)
hook	Named attachment point — where an idea lands (manuscript §7 / staging <code>#12</code> §4 for predictions; repo file; Menger chapter) before proof exists; not clickbait
PD12 guidance	Alex’s May 20 meeting summary: <code>20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md</code> — not <code>14_PD12_reassessment_memo.md</code> (COMPASS ladder memo)
axis mismatch	Empirical v1 uses LOO pool quality ; generative POC reads out on pool mean — state honestly, don’t pretend they match
scope discipline	Don’t claim more than one domain/table/mechanism actually proves (e.g. no “six causal channels estimated” from one MBB table)
sort-and-chop	Naive pool model: rank 1–N, cut into disjoint equal bins — falsified by overlap plots (<code>sports/537_tier1_benchmark.ipynb</code>)
overlap / sorting	Real pools are assortative but overlapping talent ecologies — your distinctive empirical finding (<code>sports/530_sports_pipeline.ipynb</code> CELL 8)
<code>538D</code>	Notebook <code>sports/538D_development.ipynb</code> — generative lab (CELL 10 POC + CELL 4D heterogeneity); D = development variant of 538, not “4D analysis”
CELL 4D	Sub-cell under CELL 4 in <code>538D</code> (after 4A/4B/4C) — near-threshold heterogeneity plot; letter suffix, not four dimensions. Export: <code>heterogeneity_ventiles_top_tail.png</code> (D10, <code>#08</code>)
#03 ... #14	Shorthand for numbered files in <code>3-Master_Plan/</code> (e.g. <code>#07</code> = claim guardrails)
SCOUT C1	Talent-only generative baseline fails — see <code>06_Generative_closure_checklist.md</code>

Term	Plain English
PEER C1	OpenAlex HIGH+MEDIUM tiers for tenure — see 02_Charles_decisions_locked.md

Formulas & variables (full decode): 21_Formulas_and_variables.md — every major equation + column map; use while reading #03 before #05 .

When a term isn't here: ask in chat or add to 20_feedback_questions_and_observations.md — COMPASS should expand this table when you report a miss.

COMPASS shorthand policy (chat + docs)

Shorthand keeps agents aligned; **you** should not need to decode every seventh word.

Do	Don't
Use #07 , LOO, PD12, etc. when we've defined them in this file	Assume you remember every agent coinage from June correspondence
On first use in a chat reply, add a 3–8 word gloss or (see #01)	Stack three undefined shorthands in one sentence
Name the file when citing guidance (20260520_Transcript_12_guidance.md)	Say "PD12 guidance" with no pointer if context is ambiguous
Notebook/cell cites: sports/538D_development.ipynb CELL 4D + export path — not bare "4D" or "CELL 4D" alone	Assume you know which of dozens of notebooks agents mean
Put recurring lookups in this glossary	Send you on archaeology through obsolete/ without saying so

Your feedback (2026-07): ~1 in 7 shorthands still sends you looking — treat that as a bug; expand #01 or gloss inline when you flag it.

What to do after reading (June 2026)

1. Open 5-Manuscript/Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx
2. Ink manuscript §5 → §1 → §4 (generative → empirical triad → tenure), then §0 opening frame — using #10 , #12 (staging §1 = §0), #08
3. Before manuscript §4 (tenure), open #11 — not staging §4 (predictions → manuscript §7 later)
4. Message COMPASS: "back in the game"

Glossary companion to Charles_reading_list.md .